

THE COMPLETE GUIDE TO SURVIVING A NUCLEAR ATTACK!

AS ANYONE IN TOUCH WITH THE NEWS WILL KNOW, THINGS ARE STARTING TO GET DICEY. WHILE EVERYONE HOPES FOR THE BEST, WE HELP YOU PREPARE FOR THE WORST!

BY SAHIL DAWKA
readersletters@digit.in

ALL POLITICS LEAD TO WAR

Given the current state of affairs with our neighbours, war is no longer an unlikely scenario. Tensions are high with Pakistan and it's no secret who China is posturing support. Russia too is getting into the fray with accusations about sabotaging the US presidential elections flying about, and a steady military build up near the Polish and Syrian borders. We've been one of the largest peaceful nations till now, but everything changes sooner or later. If and when the missiles start flying, chances are they're gonna be nuclear!

NOW CONSIDER THE INEVITABLE HAS HAPPENED

With all due respect to Einstein, whether you're alive in this paragraph depends on the multitude of factors too vast to enumerate. Let us abbreviate it to plain old luck. For a half-megaton bomb, the fireball radius is slightly more than 1 km and the shock and heat wave can do damage in an 8 km radius, and that's not even taking the radiation into account. You weren't close enough to be engulfed in the crater formed by the fireball, internally squished by the shockwave, or vaporized by the heatwave, but close enough to the blast that your whole life has changed (and may be drastically shortened at

any moment since everything around you is on fire). You were forewarned. Luckily, you had read this article, and jumped in the drain as soon as you saw the light. Take a moment to thank us for telling you how a large enough water body can shield you from a blast of ionizing radiation. A more important characteristic of the water body is that these days they are close enough, thanks to the municipal department for the clogged drains. Thick enough concrete and steel will protect you from radiation too, but not so much from the shock wave of the thermonuclear bomb. Instead they may bury you.



From Russia, with love

Of course, you can't stay submerged for long among the burning floating garbage. You protected yourself from the blast radiation, but now you have to make sure you escape the residual radiation. You make your way out, gaping at the iconic larger-than-life mesmerizing mushroom cloud. All around, everything ignitable is aflame and about to coalesce into a firestorm. The random kid who mimicked your dive into the drain is now following you. Soon you are asked about the burning smell. Remember to tell the little one, "It's just rubber. Let's put our backs to the cloud and keep going!" You can't find your family if you're dead.

You see more people among the debris than you expect, but the smell gets stronger as you approach them and most of them walk funny. Some occasionally let out wails and moans. A few minutes ago most of them were rioting and looting as law was suspended by public panic. Those who took shelter indoors are buried under rubble. As far as the eye can see, all structures have fallen and only dust rises. You need to find shelter soon, a real shelter that will protect you from radiation, and hopefully some able and intelligent company, at least till aid arrives. Even though you're upwind of the blast site, it's not safe to be exposed this long.